

Samuel McCarty

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First-year PhD student in Astronomy & Astrophysics at the
Center for Astrophysics | Harvard & Smithsonian
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Education	Harvard University	Cambridge, MA
	Ph.D., Astronomy & Astrophysics	09/2025 – Present
	University of Washington	Seattle, WA
	B.S. <i>magna cum laude</i> with honors in Physics and Astronomy	06/2025
	Cumulative GPA: 3.96/4.0, Physics: 3.98, Astronomy: 3.96	
Publications	McCarty S. et al. (2026b) . <i>A new measurement of the FRB DM-galaxy cross correlation and a first joint analysis with the kinematic SZ effect</i> . Submitted to PRD.	
	McCarty S., Connor L., & Konietzka R. (2026a) . <i>The CGM with local universe FRBs: evidence of strong AGN feedback in a massive elliptical galaxy</i> . ApJL.	
	McCarty S., & Connor L. (2025) . <i>Strong gravitational lensing with upcoming wide-field radio surveys</i> . MNRAS.	
	Lucchini S., Connor L., McCarty S., & Konietzka R. (2026) . <i>A New Model for the Milky Way Halo Dispersion Measure with the ENGAWA Simulations: Low DMs and Large Anisotropy</i> . Submitted to ApJ.	
	Wu Z., Connor L., McCarty S., & Bouman K. (2026) . <i>POLISH'ing the Sky: Wide-Field and High-Dynamic Range Interferometric Image Reconstruction with Application to Strong Lens Discovery</i> .	
Research	Graduate Researcher, Harvard	09/2025 – Present
	Project: FRB Cosmology, Advisor: Dr. Liam Connor	
	Caltech Summer Undergraduate Research Fellowship, CIT	03/2024 – 08/2025
	Project: Radio Strong Lensing, Advisor: Dr. Liam Connor	
	Undergraduate Researcher, University of Washington	05/2023 – 06/2025
	Project: Simulations of the IGM, Advisor: Dr. Matthew McQuinn	
	Undergraduate Researcher, University of Washington	01/2025 – 08/2025
	Project: ML biosignature detection, Advisor: Dr. Victoria Meadows	
	Undergraduate Researcher, University of Washington	06/2023 – 06/2025

Project: Quasar absorption spectroscopy, Advisor: Dr. Jessica Werk

Undergraduate Researcher, University of Washington

03/2023 – 04/2024

Project: UW Nanopore Lab, Advisor: Dr. Jens Gundlach

Posters & Presentations	<i>A new view of AGN feedback with FRBs</i>	2026
	– AGN & Energy Flows Workshop , Center for Computational Astrophysics	
	<i>Strong lensing with upcoming wide-field radio surveys</i>	2025
	– ASTRO 3D Strong Lensing in the Next Decade workshop, Harvard CfA	
	<i>Towards a Statistical Framework for HWO Biosignature Assessment</i>	2025
	– HWO2025 conference, Johns Hopkins	
Outreach & Service	<i>Structure of Cosmic Sheets and Filaments</i>	2024
	– Mary Gates Research Symposium, University of Washington	
	Astronomy on Tap Boston Organizer	2025 – Present
	<i>A History of Radio Astronomy</i> , AoT Boston	2026
	Undergrad Mentorship Program Leader (UW Physics)	2024 – 2025
	UW Mobile Planetarium Volunteer	2022 – 2025
Honors & Achievements	<i>Exploring Strong Gravitational Lensing</i>	04/24/2024
	~45-minute public outreach talk for Astronomy on Tap Seattle. Video here.	
	Outreach Coordinator (UW Astro)	2022 – 2023
	Phi Delta Theta Executive Social Chair	2023 – 2024
	NSF GRFP Honorable Mention	2026
	<i>Top Graduating Senior</i> (UW Physics)	2025
	<i>Departmental honors in both Physics and Astronomy</i> (UW)	2025
	<i>Phi Beta Kappa</i> (UW)	2025
	<i>Caltech Summer Undergraduate Research Fellowship</i>	2024
	<i>Hans G. Dehmelt Scholarship</i> (UW Physics)	2024
Observing Experience	<i>Mary Gates Research Scholarship</i> (UW)	2024
	<i>Baer Prize</i> (UW Astro)	2024
	<i>Greek Man of the Year</i> (UW)	2023
	93rd percentile Physics GRE (970/990)	
	Dean's List every quarter in undergrad	
	Very Large Array, 16 hours (ID:26A-289, PI: McCarty)	2026
Observing Experience	Keck LRIS	11/20/25
	Local Volume Mapper, Las Campanas Observatory	11/14/24 - 02/01/25
	Hale 200 Inch Telescope, Palomar Observatory	08/14/2024
	ARCSAT 0.5m Telescope, Apache Point Observatory	04/22-23/2024